

# Enough!

**WHAT IS WRONG WITH THE WORLD?** Is it just me being old, or is the world actually going just a little crazy? Not all of it mind you, there are plenty of sane people on the planet, it's just hard to focus on them when the crazies rule so much of our screen time thanks to social media.

Let's just look at what transpired in February. Fake news ruled the roost again. There were many, but people killing off a celebrity as a hoax seems to never turn old. Sylvester Stallone this time, who is alive and well, but enough people on the net think he died recently.

Sadly, there was another shooting in a US school, and regardless of your stance on guns, you will agree that kids should feel safe in schools all around the world. It's already hard enough to ensure they get a good education without them being gunned down in even supposedly developed countries. There is hope though, as the power of social media is being used by the kids to try and raise awareness about the problem. Of course it's also being used to spread more fake news – a video claimed that one of the students speaking out was an actor, and it went viral. It was later proven to be untrue, but it's not like the internet cares about truth anymore.

Back home it was pretty sane for awhile. Despite the budget raising duties on imported tech, people were still positive because it would boost Make in India. Then came social media madness, and for some reason a small clip from a Malayalam movie that showed a woman wink at a camera, and the country lost its mind! First it was positive, with her getting more Instagram followers than Mark Zuckerberg in next to no time, and then suddenly some people hated her, and it was all because of a short clip online?

The Olympics that no one cares about, the winter version, is on, and most don't even know about it! A private company shot off a car into space, with a dummy astronaut in the driver's seat, and far exceeded their own expectations in terms of thrust, but so few seemed to bat an eyelid. Yet when an actress batted one eyelid, we rushed off en masse to track her down on instagram?

It makes me wonder if we're ever going to grow up and grow out of this phase of alternate realities, and different versions of facts. At Digit, we are always going to push for rigorous testing methodologies, and skepticism and try and give as many people a scientific bent of mind – all of you magazine readers are like that already, so I'm probably preaching to the choir here.

Why do we do this? Because we choose to be right, instead of popular, or fact check instead of rushing to be first. However, I don't think we're going to be able to do it alone. I want to ask you all to join in. Social media is being taken over by trolls and troublemakers, and while you may know the truth, there are plenty who will believe anything posted as a link or a video.

Heck, we've recently had our own run in with it, where suddenly on a Flipkart product page for the Xiaomi Mi TV 4, there was a certified buyer called "digit.in" that apparently had given that product a 5 star rating. We were flabbergasted. Turns out, it was an attempt at something new in marketing, and they'd taken choice snippets from our First Look writeup about the product (not our review).

Look, our content is available online for everyone to see, and it's clear that we did not in fact rate that product as 5 stars (it got a rating of 80/100). Heck, the only thing we've ever rated at 100 percent in our entire history is India's Mangalyaan mission, and let's just say nothing can come close to that!

But for the short time this was up on Flipkart, how many people would have seen it and thought that we were somehow involved with marketing a product? Will the facts ever change their mind? This is the problem with social media now, not just for us, but for everyone, and it's going to take all of us to fix it.

No matter what you read, or watch, make sure you check that it's from a verified source – from the source's own page, and not a quote on some other page. Try and refrain from sharing anything you know is false, and when you comment on stuff that is false, make sure to speak up and say it. If you don't, there will be too many people who will be fooled by the trolls. It's time we all said "Enough! No more." Will you do it? 



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